

Age Like Fine Wine

Skin & Beauty Hacks for Women Who Refuse to Fade

By Auntie V & Bella Mist
The Slay Hack Collection

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Skin & Beauty Hacks for Women Who Refuse to Fade

The Slay Hack Collection - Beauty Series

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Required Reader Note

B+C Hybrid Visual System

This guide is for general beauty education and personal routine planning. It is not medical advice, dermatology advice, or a substitute for care from a qualified professional. Skin needs vary by person. Patch test new products, follow product labels, use SPF as directed, and talk with a licensed professional if you have a medical skin concern, active irritation, prescription skincare, pregnancy-related restrictions, or uncertainty about ingredients such as retinoids or collagen supplements.

B+C Hybrid Visual System

This editable source uses the approved B+C Hybrid direction: chapter host cards, reusable character tip boxes, visual checklists, and selected full-panel moments.

Chapter opener reference

Full panel reference

Tip box reference

Chapter 1: The Fine Wine Manifesto

Host character: Auntie V

Visual direction: Portrait opener, manifesto quote card, closing toast panel.

Chapter 1: The Fine Wine Manifesto A letter from Auntie V Darling, Let me tell you something nobody else will.

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You didn't peak at 25. You didn't "let yourself go" because you stopped buying the latest TikTok serum. And you certainly don't need

to "look younger" · you need to look like the most radiant version of exactly who you are right now.

I'm Auntie V. I'm 55. I wear bold red lipstick every single day. I have silver hair that I earned through decades of living fully. And I've never

felt more beautiful than I do right now.

Here's what I know for certain: aging isn't decline. It's refinement.

Think about it · nobody says a fine wine peaked at grape juice stage.

Nobody looks at a vintage Chanel bag and says "it was better when it was new." The most expensive things in the world are the ones that

have aged with grace.

That's you, babe.

This book isn't about "anti-aging." I hate that phrase. It implies aging is something to fight against, like it's an enemy at the gate. It's not.

It's a privilege denied to many.

What this book IS about:

Understanding what's actually changing in your skin and body (knowledge is power)

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Simple, effective hacks that work WITH your skin, not against it Looking refreshed, radiant, and put-together in minimal time

Embracing the confidence that only comes with experience Building rituals that make you feel luxurious, not exhausted

I've gathered my best advice, along with wisdom from my favorite Slay Objects · Bella Mist (who knows about lasting elegance), Sera

(who understands the science), Sunny (who will NOT let you skip SPF), and the rest of the squad.

Every hack in this book has been tested. Every tip is practical. And every chapter ends with a reminder that you're not trying to turn

back time · you're making right now absolutely stunning.

Ready? Let's pour ourselves a glass of something beautiful and get started.

With love and zero apologies, Auntie V

SLAY OBJECT TIP · BELLA MIST "Elegance isn't about looking 25 forever. It's about looking like you've

always known exactly who you are. That kind of confidence? It's intoxicating."

Chapter 2: The Skincare Reboot

Host character: Sera

Visual direction: Chapter opener mockup, skincare layering diagram, Sera science callouts.

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C H A P T E R T W O The Skincare Reboot Rebuilding Your Routine for 35+ Skin Chapter 2: The Skincare Reboot

Here's the truth nobody tells you at the beauty counter: the routine that worked at 28 is actively working against you at 38.

Your skin at 35+ is fundamentally different. Not worse · different.

Cell turnover slows from every 28 days to every 45-60 days. Collagen production drops about 1% per year after 30. Your skin barrier gets

thinner. Oil production decreases.

This isn't bad news. It's just information. And information means we can adapt.

Morning Routine (5 minutes) Step 1: Gentle Cleanser (not foaming)

Foaming cleansers strip your already-thinning barrier. Switch to a

cream or oil-based cleanser that cleans without that "squeaky clean"

feeling.

THE HACK If your skin feels tight after washing, your cleanser is too harsh. Period.

Step 2: Vitamin C Serum This is your morning MVP. Vitamin C brightens, protects against

environmental damage, and boosts collagen production. Apply to damp skin for better absorption.

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THE HACK Store your Vitamin C in the fridge. It oxidizes (turns orange) faster at

room temperature. If it's orange, it's dead. Throw it out.

Step 3: Moisturizer with Peptides Peptides are signal molecules that tell your skin to produce more

collagen. They're gentle enough for daily use and effective enough to make a real difference over 8-12 weeks.

THE HACK Apply moisturizer while your serum is still slightly damp. This "moisture

sandwich" locks everything in.

Step 4: SPF 50 (non-negotiable) SPF is the single most effective anti-aging product that exists.

Everything else is secondary.

THE HACK Use SPF as your last skincare step, not your first makeup step. Give it

2-3 minutes to set before foundation.

Evening Routine (7 minutes) Step 1: Double Cleanse First, an oil-based cleanser to dissolve makeup and sunscreen. Then

your gentle cream cleanser to clean the skin itself.

THE HACK Massage the oil cleanser for 60 seconds minimum. This is also a mini facial massage that boosts circulation.

Step 2: Retinol (2-3 nights per week) Retinol is the gold standard for skin renewal. It speeds up cell

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turnover, boosts collagen, and fades dark spots. But at 35+, you need to be strategic · more isn't better.

THE HACK Start with 0.25% retinol, 2 nights per week. Apply to completely dry skin

(wait 20 minutes after washing) to reduce irritation.

Step 3: Rich Night Cream or Facial Oil Your skin repairs itself at night. Give it the building blocks. Look for

ceramides, squalane, or rosehip oil.

THE HACK Warm the product between your palms for 5 seconds before pressing (not rubbing) into skin. The warmth helps absorption.

Step 4: Eye Cream The skin around your eyes is 10x thinner than the rest of your face. It

needs its own product. Look for caffeine (de-puffs), peptides (firms), and retinol (smooths).

THE HACK Apply eye cream with your ring finger using tiny tapping motions. Your ring finger applies the least pressure naturally.

SLAY OBJECT TIP · SERA "You've been layering it wrong. Thinnest to thickest, always. Serum before

moisturizer, oil last. And wait 30 seconds between each step. Let each layer absorb. Patience isn't just a virtue, it's a skincare requirement."

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The "Skin Cycling" Method for 35+ Night Product Purpose Night 1 Retinol
Renewal & cell turnover

Night 2 Exfoliating acid (AHA) Brighten & smooth texture Night 3
Recovery (moisturizer only)

Repair barrier Night 4 Recovery (moisturizer only) Repair barrier
Products to STOP Using After 35

Harsh physical scrubs (micro-tears in thinner skin) Alcohol-based toners
(strips barrier)

Mattifying products (you need that oil now) Anything that makes your
skin feel "tight"

Products to START Using After 35 Peptide serums (collagen support)
Ceramide moisturizers (barrier repair)

Facial oils (nourishment) Chemical exfoliants over physical (gentler,
more effective)

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That full-coverage foundation you've been wearing since your twenties? It's aging you by 10 years.

Why Full Coverage Backfires After 35: When skin is young and plump, heavy foundation sits on a smooth surface. After 35, your skin

has more texture. Full coverage doesn't hide these things · it highlights them.

The "Skin First" Approach Step 1: Primer (the right kind) Skip mattifying primers. You want a hydrating, blurring primer that

fills fine lines temporarily.

THE HACK Apply primer only to your T-zone and around your nose. Skip the cheeks if they're not textured.

Step 2: Choose the Right Formula Skin Concern Best Formula Avoid Fine lines Serum foundation or skin tint

Powder foundation Dryness Cream foundation with oils Matte formulas Dark spots Medium-coverage liquid

Full-coverage Redness Tinted moisturizer + concealer Heavy layers Step 3: The "Spot Concealing" Method

Apply a thin layer of tinted moisturizer everywhere (1 pump max) Use a small concealer brush to spot-conceal only where needed

Blend the edges of concealer with a damp sponge Leave the rest of your skin visible

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Step 4: Setting (the gentle way) Do NOT bake. On 35+ skin, it creates a dry, cakey, cracked look within

hours.

THE HACK Use a finely-milled setting powder on a fluffy brush. Lightly dust ONLY

your T-zone and under-eye area. Leave cheeks powder-free.

Step 5: The "Press and Roll" Application Dot product on forehead, cheeks, nose, chin

Use a damp beauty blender to PRESS (not swipe) product into skin Roll the sponge over fine lines · pushes product INTO lines

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SLAY OBJECT TIP · FIONA "Stop dragging that sponge like you're painting a wall. Your face is not a

wall. Press, bounce, blend. And if you can see your foundation, you're wearing too much. The best foundation is the one nobody notices."

The "No Foundation" Alternative: The 3-Product Face Color-correcting

Chapter 4: The Eye Area Masterclass Concealer That Doesn't Crease, Shadow That Doesn't Settle

Part 1: Under-Eye Concealer That Actually Works The Problem: You apply concealer under your eyes. It looks great for

20 minutes. Then it creases into every fine line.

The Fix · The "Less is More" Method:

Hydrate first. Apply eye cream and let it absorb for 3 minutes minimum.

Use a hydrating concealer. Look for "radiant" or "luminous" on the label.

Apply in a thin line, not a triangle. Apply directly on your dark circle only.

Blend with warmth. Use your ring finger to tap (not swipe).

Set with a TINY amount of powder. One layer only.

THE HACK Spray setting spray on your beauty blender, then bounce it over your set under-eye area. This "melts" the powder into the concealer, creating

a crease-proof seal.

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Build color in thin layers. Multiple thin layers last longer than one thick layer.

Skip shimmer in the crease. Save shimmer for the center of the lid only.

Tightline instead of heavy liner. Push dark shadow INTO your upper lash line.

THE HACK Spray your eyeshadow brush with setting spray before dipping into shadow. This intensifies color AND makes it last 2-3x longer.

Part 3: The Lifted Eye Effect Angle your shadow upward. Blend toward the tail of your

eyebrow · never downward.

Highlight the inner corner. Champagne shimmer opens up the eye instantly.

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Curl your lashes. Hold curler 10 seconds at base, 5 seconds at mid-point.

Skip lower liner. Use nude/white pencil on waterline to brighten.

Chapter 5: SPF · Your Non-Negotiable The Real Anti-Aging Product If you could only use ONE product for the rest of your life, it should

be sunscreen. Up to 90% of visible skin aging is caused by UV exposure. Not genetics. Not time. The sun.

The SPF Rules for 35+ Skin Rule 1: SPF 50, Every Single Day Even on cloudy days (80% of UV penetrates clouds). Even in winter.

Even if you work from home (UVA penetrates windows).

THE HACK Keep a bottle of SPF by your front door. If you forgot during your routine, you catch it before leaving.

Rule 2: Two Finger Lengths Most people apply 25-50% of the SPF they need. The correct amount

is two finger-lengths.

Rule 3: Reapply Every 2 Hours (If Outdoors)

THE HACK Use a SPF setting spray or powder for reapplication over makeup. Pat (don't rub) over your face.

Rule 4: Choose the Right Formula Formula Best For Avoid If Chemical SPF Daily wear under makeup

Sensitive/reactive skin Mineral SPF Sensitive skin, rosacea You hate white cast Tinted SPF

Replacing foundation You need heavy coverage SPF moisturizer Minimal routine lovers

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Lots of time outdoors The Best SPF Hack: Tinted Sunscreen A good tinted SPF with iron oxides does THREE things: protects from

UV, protects from blue light, and evens out skin tone. One product.

Full protection. Done in 30 seconds.

Rule 5: Don't Forget These Areas Neck and chest · age faster than your face Backs of hands · the #1 area that reveals age

Ears · especially if you wear hair up Lips · use a lip balm with SPF 30+

SLAY OBJECT TIP · SUNNY · · · · "Did you reapply? DID YOU REAPPLY?! I'm not being dramatic · I'm being

scientific. Every hour without me is an hour of damage you can't undo.

UVA goes through windows, babe. THROUGH. WINDOWS. I rest my case."

Reader safety note: Check product labels and professional guidance before making skincare or supplement changes. Results vary by person.

Chapter 6: The 10-Minute Elevated Look

Host character: Ruby

Visual direction: Ten-minute timeline, product swap card, cream blush panel.

C H A P T E R S I X The 10-Minute Elevated Look Sophisticated Makeup That Takes Years Off

Chapter 6: The 10-Minute Elevated Look Here's the paradox: the more makeup you put on after 35, the older

you can look. But the RIGHT products, applied strategically, can make you look refreshed and five years younger in under 10 minutes.

The 10-Minute Elevated Face Minutes 1-2: The Base Tinted SPF or skin tint (1 pump, pressed in with fingers)

Concealer on dark circles and redness (ring finger, tapping) One light dust of powder on T-zone only

Minutes 3-4: The Eyes Cream shadow stick in champagne/taupe (swipe, blend with finger)

One coat of brown mascara (softer than black) Curl lashes if you have 10 extra seconds

Minutes 5-6: The Cheeks Cream blush in warm rose or peach (apply to apples, blend

upward) · · This is the single most "youthful" step

THE HACK Apply cream blush OVER your powder. This creates a dewy, skin-like finish on cheeks while keeping T-zone matte.

Minutes 7-8: The Lips Lip liner close to natural lip color (slightly overline cupid's bow)

Hydrating lipstick or tinted lip balm Tiny bit of gloss in center of lower lip for dimension

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Minutes 9-10: Finishing Touches Cream highlighter on cheekbones, nose bridge, cupid's bow

Setting spray · 3 spritzes in an X pattern 5 Products That Make You Look Younger

Product Why It Works Cream blush (warm tone) Mimics youthful flush Illuminating primer

Creates "lit from within" glow Brown mascara Softer than black, opens eyes Hydrating lip color

Plumps and adds life Cream highlighter Adds dimension without texture · 5 Products That Age You

Product Replace With Powder foundation Skin tint or tinted moisturizer Black liquid liner (thick)

Brown pencil or tightlining Dark matte lipstick Hydrating formula in medium tone

Powder contour Cream bronzer, applied lightly Glitter eyeshadow Satin or shimmer (not glitter)

SLAY OBJECT TIP · ROSIE "Here's the secret about blush after 35 · placement changes everything.

Put me on the TOPS of your cheeks, almost on the cheekbone, and blend UP toward your temples. Instant facelift. You're welcome."

Chapter 7: Neck, Hands & the Forgotten Zones

Host character: Auntie V

Visual direction: Forgotten-zone checklist and hand SPF tip card.

Chapter 7: Neck, Hands & the Forgotten Zones Where Aging Shows First and How to Address It

You can have the most flawless face routine in the world, but if you're neglecting your neck, chest, and hands, there's a visible disconnect.

The Neck & Chest Protocol Daily (Add 60 seconds to your routine):

Extend everything down. Whatever you put on your face · bring it to your chest.

Apply in upward strokes. Always smooth from chest UP toward chin.

SPF is critical here. The chest shows sun damage faster than almost anywhere.

THE HACK Sleep on your back or use a silk pillowcase. Side sleeping creates "sleep

wrinkles" on the chest. Silk reduces friction by 40%.

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The Hands Protocol Daily Non-Negotiables:

SPF on hands every morning. Keep a small SPF in your car.

Hand cream after every wash. Keep tubes everywhere.

Wear gloves when cleaning. Harsh chemicals accelerate aging.

THE HACK Before bed, apply thick hand cream + cotton gloves for 20 minutes. This

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Reversing Existing Damage Concern Solution Dark/age spots on hands
Vitamin C daily + SPF. For stubborn spots: IPL

Crepey texture on chest Retinol 2x/week + rich moisturizer + SPF "Tech
neck" lines

Reduce phone angle + retinol on neck Visible veins on hands Hydration
(plumps skin)

SLAY OBJECT TIP · SUNNY 1.

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"Your hands, babe. YOUR HANDS. They're out there every day completely
unprotected. Apply me to your hands every morning. Every. Single.

Morning. And reapply after you wash them. I'll wait."

Chapter 8: Self-Care Isn't Selfish

Host character: Jade

Visual direction: Evening ritual full panel and weekly reset card.

C H A P T E R E I G H T Self-Care Isn't Selfish Building a Ritual That's
Just for You

Chapter 8: Self-Care Isn't Selfish If you're 35+, chances are you're
taking care of everyone except

yourself. Here's your permission slip: self-care isn't selfish. It's
maintenance.

Level 1: Daily Micro-Rituals (5-15 minutes) The Morning Ritual (10
minutes before anyone wakes):

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Sit in silence. No phone. No news. No to-do list.

Apply your skincare slowly, intentionally The Evening Wind-Down (15 minutes before bed):

Phone on airplane mode 30 minutes before sleep Light a candle Do your evening skincare as a ritual, not a rush

Apply a scent that signals "rest time" to your brain

THE HACK Attach self-care to existing habits. "After I brush my teeth, I do my skincare." Habit stacking makes it automatic.

· · · Level 2: Weekly Reset (1-2 hours) A longer skincare treatment (mask, facial massage, gua sha)

Something that brings joy that isn't productive A phone call with someone who energizes you

THE HACK Put it in your calendar as a non-negotiable appointment. If someone asks if you're free, the answer is "no."

Level 3: Monthly Restoration (Half day) A professional facial or massage A solo lunch at a restaurant you love

An afternoon at a bookstore or museum A long bath with zero interruptions The Beauty-Self-Care Connection

Chronic stress affects your skin through increased cortisol (breaks down collagen), poor sleep (reduced cell repair), and tension (frown

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lines, jaw clenching). When you invest in self-care, you're literally investing in your skin.

SLAY OBJECT TIP · BELLA MIST · · "When you spray me before your evening ritual, your body learns: 'Oh,

we're relaxing now.' That's not vanity. That's neuroscience. You're training your nervous system to calm down. Your perfume IS self-care."

Chapter 9: The 30-Day Glow Up Challenge

Host character: Rosie

Visual direction: Calendar challenge grid with character icon notes.

Chapter 9: The 30-Day Glow Up Challenge Designed for Women 35+ Each day has ONE focus. One small action. No overwhelm. No

perfection required. Just consistency.

Week 1: Foundation (Days 1-7) Day Focus Action 1 SPF Apply SPF today. Set a daily alarm.

2 Hydration Drink 8 glasses of water. Track it.

3 Sleep Go to bed 30 minutes earlier.

4 Declutter Throw away 3 expired beauty products.

5 Skincare Do your full AM + PM routine.

6 Movement 20 minutes of any movement.

7 Rest 15 minutes of complete silence.

Week 2: Upgrade (Days 8-14) Day Focus Action 8 Retinol Start retinol tonight.

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10 Eyes Practice "less is more" concealer method.

11 Neck Extend routine to neck and chest.

12 Blush Try cream blush on high points.

13 Brows Groom your brows.

14 Lips Exfoliate + overnight lip mask.

Week 3: Elevate (Days 15-21) Day Focus Action 15 10-Min Look Practice the full elevated look.

16 Self-Care 15-minute face mask + music.

17 Wardrobe Pick 3 outfits for the week.

18 Posture Set 3 posture check alarms.

19 Compliment 3 genuine compliments in the mirror.

20 Gua Sha 5-minute facial massage.

21 Digital Detox No social media for 4 hours.

Week 4: Sustain (Days 22-30) Day Focus Action 22 Review Adjust what's not working.

23 Nourish Cook one genuinely nourishing meal.

24 Gratitude Write 5 things you're grateful for.

25 Treat Buy ONE product you've been wanting.

26 Share Share one hack with a friend.

27 Photos Take a selfie. Compare to Day 1.

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your skincare, actually feel it. The glow comes from slowing down, not from adding more products. Trust me · I'm literally made of stone that

took millions of years to form. Patience works."

Reader safety note: Check product labels and professional guidance before making skincare or supplement changes. Results vary by person.

Chapter 10: Auntie V's Closing Letter

Host character: Auntie V

Visual direction: Closing letter portrait and group celebration panel.

C H A P T E R T E N Auntie V's Closing Letter "Age Is a Privilege. Wear It Like a Crown."

Chapter 10: Auntie V's Closing Letter My darling, If you've made it to this page, you've done something most people

never do: you invested time in yourself. And I'm so proud of you for that.

Let me leave you with a few truths I've collected over 55 years of living loudly:

Truth #1: There is no "letting yourself go."

There is only "choosing where your energy goes." And if your energy went to raising humans, building a career, surviving hard seasons ·

that's not "letting go." That's living.

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Truth #2: The most attractive thing about a woman over 35 is her certainty.

Not her skin. Not her weight. Her certainty. The way she walks into a room knowing exactly who she is. That energy? No serum can give

you that.

Truth #3: Comparison is the thief of joy.

Those women on Instagram who "don't age"? Filters. Botox.

Professional lighting. Facetune. That's not real life. Real life is laugh lines from years of genuine joy.

Truth #4: It's never too late.

Too late to start retinol? No. Too late to wear bold lipstick? Absolutely not. Too late to feel beautiful? Not while I'm around.

Truth #5: You don't owe anyone your youth.

You don't owe the world a smooth forehead. You don't owe social media a "glow up." Your face, your rules. Always.

Every morning, before you reach for your phone, look in the mirror and say:

"I am not aging. I am evolving."

You are fine wine, darling. And you only get better from here.

With all my love, my bold red lip, and zero apologies, Auntie V THE ENTIRE SLAY SQUAD SAYS

Ruby: "You're never too old for bold red lipstick. NEVER."

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Bella Mist: "Elegance has no expiration date. Neither do you."

Sera: "Treat your skin with respect and it will glow at any age."

Sunny: "I'll protect you today, tomorrow, and every day after."

Rosie: "You're glowing, babe. You've ALWAYS been glowing."

Your Slay Journey Doesn't End Here

Continue the glow-up path after this guide is fully approved for sale.

Locked CTA: Age Like Fine Wine is in final QA review. Public checkout opens only after Captain approval.